

[GAME NAME] — QUICK REFERENCE (Core Rules v4)

Character Creation

Three choices of history hand you most of a character. Everything starts at **d4**; you get **two Attribute improvements** — two Attributes to d6, or one to d8. Defense, Reserves, and Hit Points all follow from the dice, so none of them is bought.

Step	What it gives you
1. Origin	Where you were raised: two Skills, an armor or weapon access, a kit.
2. Trade	What you did for a living: two Skills, more access, one Creation Feature.
3. The Turn	What put you on the road: one Skill, and two Traits that suit it.
4. Attributes	Two improvements. Defense = die max / 2 · Reserve = die max · HP = 4 + twice Vigor max.
5. Traits	Two free. A weakness Trait grants another at no cost.
6. Coin & points	100 gold, plus 6 Creation Points: Skill 2 · Trait 3 · 2nd Feature 4 · access 1-3 · School 4 · +50g 1.

A Trade that repeats a Skill your Origin gave you is not wasted — take any other Skill in its place. Level 1 grants no Talent; the first is earned at level 2.

Your Turn: 3 Action Points

Every action costs **1 AP** — **no exceptions**. Reserve and Momentum spend governs how *strong* your actions are; AP only governs how *many*.

Category	Baseline actions (1 AP each)
Attacks	Basic Attack: 1 Attribute Die (Vigor melee / Agility ranged or Finesse), no cost. Featured Attack: + Reserve/Momentum cost from its Talent or spell entry.
Defends	Guard: Impact Rolls against you are Downgraded until your next turn (tunable).
Maneuvers	Move up to Base Speed (repeatable) · Stand from Prone · Disengage (no Opportunity Attacks this turn).
Interactions	Draw/stow a Readied item · retrieve Stowed · use object · treat a wound / extinguish · Scrutinize an illusion.
Spellcasting	Cast a spell (+ its Reserve cost by Tier) · drive a Channel (any other AP spent breaks it).

Reactions: one per round, regained at the start of your turn — Opportunity Attacks, Grab/Redirect/Parry (free hand), Intercept (shield), Reaction spells and Talents. **Free-Action riders** trigger off actions and cost Momentum or Reserve, never AP.

Impact Rolls — no to-hit, ever

1) Roll your Impact Pool. 2) Add the dice. 3) Subtract the target's Defense Rating; the remainder is damage. **Glancing Blow** (total ≤ Defense): zero damage, attacker gains 1 Momentum. **Explosion:** a die at maximum rerolls and adds — infinitely. **Vicious:** exploding dice Upgrade one step per cascade. Max **one bonus die** per roll unless a feature says otherwise; extra points Upgrade that bonus die instead.

Die	d4	d6	d8	d10	d12
Defense (max/2)	2	3	4	5	6

Momentum

Personal pool, **cap 3** (Talents raise it). **Resets to 0 when combat starts**. Generate: your attack Glances +1 · your spell is Saved against +1 · your Task fails by 1–2 +1 / by 3+ +2 · plus your generator Talents. Spend (declare before rolling): **flat** — 1 token = +1 to your roll or an ally's within engagement (shareable); **Talent** — effects priced in the Talent's entry, always self-only.

Cover & Positioning

Light Cover (1/3 obscured): +1 Vigor/Agility Defense, attacker Downgrades Impact Die. **Heavy Cover** (1/2 obscured): +2, attacker Downgrades whole pool; fully hidden = untargetable. Cover never helps against Focus/Resolve attacks. Force damage ignores Cover. Leaving melee reach without Disengaging provokes an Opportunity Attack (their Reaction).

Tasks & Saves

Difficulty	Target	Feels like
Routine	3	Trained people manage it under pressure
Challenging	5	Demands skill and focus
Demanding	7	Limit of reliable achievement
Extreme	9	Legendary careers are made of these

Fail by 1–2: near miss, +1 Momentum. Fail by 3+: complication, +2 Momentum. Assist: helper rolls vs 3; success Upgrades the actor's die (one helper max). Group Task: majority carries. **Saves** use the same mechanic but are reactive; your own failed Save generates nothing — a resisted caster gains 1 Momentum.

Spell Tiers

Tier	Reserve	Impact Dice	Save Difficulty
0	0	1 Focus Die	5
1	1–2 Focus	1 Focus Die	5
2	3–4 Focus	2 Focus Dice	7
3	5–6 Focus	3 Focus Dice	9

Sustained: 1 Focus at the start of your turns + Concentration Save when damaged (Focus Die vs 5 + 2×tier). Channeled: 1 AP each turn; any other action breaks it.

Armor and Spellcasting

Worn	Effect on casting
Arcane Vestments / Light armor	None.
Medium armor	Downgrade the Focus Die on spell Impact Rolls and Concentration Saves.
Heavy armor	As Medium, and Tier 2+ spells cannot be cast at all.

Wearing armor you lack access to Downgrades all four Attribute Dice on top of this.

Conditions (one-liners)

Dazed no Reactions; next Impact Die Downgraded	Sundered –1 to a named Defense (stacks, floor 0)
Bleeding 2 True Damage/turn until treated (1 AP)	Burning stated Fire damage/turn until doused (1 AP)
Restrained Speed 0; attacks vs you Upgraded	Grappled Speed 0; 1 AP + Vigor Save 5 to break
Prone Speed 0 until you stand (1 AP); melee vs you Upgraded, ranged Downgraded	Slowed Speed reduced; no Speed bonuses
Blinded your Impact Rolls Downgraded; no Cover	Silenced no speech, no Verbal spells
Frightened Downgraded vs source; can't approach it	Exhausted all four Attribute Dice Downgraded
Invisible/Concealed attacks vs you Downgraded	Hidden untargetable by single-target attacks
Incapacitated no actions, movement, or speech	Marked source's allies gain the stated benefit

Dying, Healing, Resting

0 HP: Incapacitated; Vigor Save vs 5 each turn — three successes stabilize, three failures kill, a max roll that Explodes puts you up at 1 HP. Any healing brings you back up. **Short Rest** (30 min + supplies): heal a Vigor Die roll. **Long Rest** (6h + 2h light): full HP and all Reserves; Decay cleansed.